

After your baby is born

Shortly after your baby's birth, the cord will be cut and your uterus will start to contract again to deliver the placenta.

The third stage

This is from the birth of your baby until the delivery of the membranes (the amniotic sac that surrounded your baby) and placenta. The placenta can be actively managed with the help of drugs or delivered without drugs, known as passive management or a physiological third stage. Your doctor will discuss these options with you before labor.

Cutting the cord Once your baby has been delivered, it may be left for two to three minutes before it is cut. Allowing the cord to pulsate for a few minutes means your baby receives more blood from the placenta, which boosts his or her oxygen supply and blood volume. The cord will be clamped in two places, about 1 cm and 4 cm from the baby's belly, and is cut with scissors between the clamps.



The umbilical cord will be clamped and cut a few minutes after the birth, severing the link between your baby and the placenta.

Delivery of the placenta How your placenta is delivered depends on your doctor. Many wait for it to happen naturally, but others offer an intramuscular (IM) injection of an oxytocin in your thigh to make the uterus contract so that you can deliver the placenta and membranes quickly. Helping the uterus contract in this way reduces the risk of